

POLI SCI 490

Statistical Computing Workshop

2026-2027

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Overview

The Statistical Computing Workshop is a year-long series that meets three times per quarter during the academic year. The purpose of the workshop is to learn, practice, and update cutting edge statistical programming skills as they apply to quantitative and computational social science.

Workshop meetings will feature internal or external speakers introducing a new tool, method, approach, or practice. All meetings are hybrid or fully virtual.

The workshop is open to everyone. Graduate students in political science formally enrolled in the corresponding version of POLI_SCI 490 will receive full credit by attending to every meeting.

The aim is to present topics that are equally useful for new and advanced users. So if you see a topic that you are already confident on, chances are that you will still learn something new.

Schedule

Fall 2026 (12:30 – 2:00 PM)

Mini Series: Computational Tools for Qualitative Inquiry

October 6: Qin Huang (University of Rhode Island)

“Computational Typology: Classifying Regional Economies in China”

October 20: Ali Sanaei (University of Chicago)

“Simulating Realistic Focus Group Discussions Using Large Language Models”

November 4: Jake Bowers (University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign)

“Two fully specified Bayes factors for hypothesis testing and sensitivity analysis in process tracing”

Winter 2027

Details to be announced

Spring 2027

Details to be announced

Details Subject to Change

Please note that the specifics of this workshop are subject to change in the case of unforeseen circumstances.